CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

LPN / LVN IN THE AI ERA

Real nursing — meds, wounds, IVs — without the four-year degree runway.

★ **TL;DR — Around $45K median after 6–12 months of training. The catch: you work under RNs and doctors, and the ceiling shows up fast unless you bridge up later.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

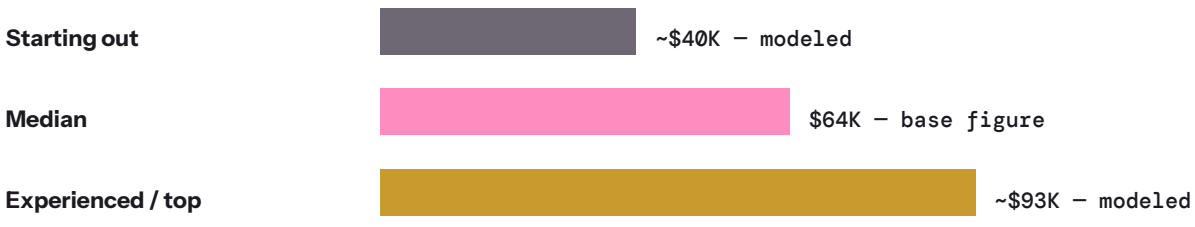
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$64K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK LOW · STATE LICENSE

- Fastest real-nurse route on this list: a 6–12 month program puts you on a ward while degree students are still in prerequisites.
- The work is genuinely clinical — medications, wound care, vitals, charting — not an aide's task list with a nurse's title.
- AI risk is low because the job is physical and patient-facing; the risk is the pay ceiling, not the robot.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for LPN / LVN is a ~$64K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A LPN / LVN ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Give scheduled medications and watch for reactions

- ✓ Take vitals, change dressings, insert catheters and start IVs where the state allows
- ✓ Chart everything — your notes are the legal record of the patient's day
- ✓ Report changes in a patient's condition to the RN or doctor fast

Think: the front-line nurse of the ward — you see the patient most, the RN directs the plan.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Charting software drafts notes, flags abnormal vitals and assembles med lists — the documentation layer is automating first. Pill-dispensing and monitoring systems keep eating the routine checks.	Hands on a real body: injections, wounds, a frightened patient at 3 a.m. Nobody automates noticing that a patient 'just looks worse today' — that judgment is the job.

⚠ **The scope ceiling is real: you cannot do everything an RN does, and in many workplaces the pay gap stays wide even when the shifts look identical.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Clinical work within a year of deciding ✓ Every setting hires: hospitals, nursing homes, clinics, home health ✓ A bridge to RN exists if you want it later	✗ Nights, weekends and holidays are the schedule, not the exception ✗ Heavy patients, bodily fluids, emotional days ✗ You take orders in a hierarchy — some people chafe at that forever

Good fit? You want real patient care fast, stay calm in messy moments, and can handle a hierarchy while you build experience.
Bad fit? You want full autonomy over care decisions now, or a desk — this is neither.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — THE ACCREDITED LPN/LVN PROGRAM	DOOR B — EMPLOYER-SPONSORED TRAINEE SEATS
Apply to an accredited practical-nursing program at a community college or technical school — the 6–12 month standard route. Clinical rotations are built in, and graduation makes you eligible for the credential exam.	Some hospital systems and large nursing-home groups sponsor cohorts: you work as an aide while training, with a job waiting at the end. Fewer seats, real competition — but little or no tuition risk.

Smart move: Pick the program by its exam pass rate and clinical placement sites, not by the brochure — and ask local facilities which school's graduates they hire without blinking.

Where you land after: Experienced LPN → charge nurse in long-term care, clinic lead — or the LPN-to-RN bridge when you want the ceiling gone.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
CONFIRM YOUR	CLEAR THE	ENROLL IN	TRAIN LIKE	PASS THE	TAKE THE

STEP 1 — Confirm your state and scope

FREE · TODAY

- Check your state's practical-nurse scope of practice — what LPNs may do varies by state.
- List accredited programs near you and their start dates; cohorts fill early.

STEP 2 — Clear the entry requirements

FREE-LOW COST · 2-4 WEEKS

- Most programs want a high-school diploma, basic science grades and a background check.
- Get healthcare CPR/BLS certified — cheap, fast, and required before clinicals.

STEP 3 — Enroll in the program

TUITION VARIES · 6-12 MONTHS

- Classroom: pharmacology, anatomy, nursing fundamentals.
- Clinicals run alongside — real patients, supervised, from early in the program.

STEP 4 — Train like the exam is the job

INCLUDED · THROUGHOUT

- Medication math and pharmacology are where students sink — drill them weekly.
- Treat every clinical shift as a working interview; preceptors hire.

STEP 5 — Pass the credential exam

EXAM FEE · AFTER GRADUATION

- Sit the NCLEX-PN as soon as you're eligible — momentum matters.
- Register with your state board and complete its credential process.

STEP 6 — Take the first nursing job

JOB HUNT · 2-6 WEEKS

- Hospitals, long-term care and clinics all hire new LPNs; long-term care usually hires fastest.
- Your first year is where the real training happens — pick the unit with the strongest preceptors.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: check your state's LPN scope and list accredited programs with start dates.
- □ Days 1–30: apply to your top two programs; start CPR/BLS certification.
- □ Days 31–60: finish entry paperwork, immunizations and background check; line up finances.
- □ Days 61–90: confirm your seat and start date; brush up on anatomy basics before day one.
- □ Day 90: you're in the pipeline — enrolled, certified in CPR, and counting down 6–12 months to the exam.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ REAL NURSING. SHORTER RUNWAY. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.